

Types of muscle

There are three types of muscle in the body. Skeletal muscle pulls the bones, for example, when we walk. Cardiac muscle makes the heart pump blood. Smooth muscle pushes food along the digestive system and urine out of the bladder, among other functions.

Body movers

The skeletal muscles attached to our bones are under our conscious control. When we decide to make a movement, our brain instructs the right muscles to contract, or shorten.



Skeletal muscle fibers look striped under the microscope. Their overlapping filaments, or strands, work together to make a muscle contract.

